For those passionate about art and craft, the state unfolds as a rich repository, featuring vibrant handicrafts, exquisite textiles, and intricately crafted jewellery. The lively markets and festive celebrations, such as Navratri—recognized as the world's longest dance festival—offer a sensory delight, providing a window into the lively and dynamic essence of Gujarati culture.

Gujarat draws wildlife enthusiasts with its unique offerings. The Gir National Park shelters the last surviving population of Asiatic lions, providing an awe-inspiring experience for those fascinated by these majestic creatures. On the other hand, the Marine National Park, nestled at the Gulf of Kutch, opens up a fascinating underwater realm, making it an ideal haven for marine life enthusiasts. The state's varied landscapes, spanning from the arid expanses of the Rann of Kutch to the lush greenery of the Saputara hills, offer a visual feast for nature enthusiasts.

Gujarat, a culinary paradise, delights the palate with its varied and delicious vegetarian cuisine. Whether savouring the tangy dhokla or indulging in the sweetness of jalebi, each dish in Gujarat transforms every meal into a celebration of rich flavours and enticing aromas.

Whether you yearn for spiritual tranquillity, a journey through history, or a serene escape surrounded by natural beauty, Gujarat ensures a rewarding and unforgettable experience, inviting you to embark on a journey through its timeless landscapes. Let's dive into the enchanting magic within this captivating corner of India.

Achievements and New Beginnings

In recent years, Gujarat's tourism sector has experienced significant growth, leading to a notable increase in tourist visits. **According to the latest India Tourism Statistics 2023 report from the Ministry of Tourism, Government of India, Gujarat holds the top position in the country for foreign tourist footfall and ranks fifth for domestic tourist footfall**. The report highlights that Gujarat attracts 1.78 million foreign tourists, contributing to a substantial 20.70% share in India, and hosts 135.81 million domestic tourists, accounting for a noteworthy 7.85% share in the country.

To promote tourism, the Tourism Department of Gujarat has undertaken various initiatives. Notably, the development of the AATITHYAM Portal, a first in India, stands out as a significant step in this direction. The department continues to implement crucial measures aimed at further enhancing tourism in Gujarat.



- **SPIRITUAL TOURISM:** Gujarat's spiritual essence unfolds through ancient legends and sacred destinations like Ambaji, Dwarka, Somnath, Pavagadh, Koteshwar Mahadev, Mata no Madh and Madhavpur. Each site offers a unique pilgrimage experience, inviting travellers to explore the threads of myth, devotion, and history woven into Gujarat's spiritual heritage.



- **ECO-TOURISM, WILDLIFE EXPLORATION, AND WEEKEND GETAWAYS:** Gujarat's eco-tourism weaves sustainability into its essence. From Rann Utsav's vibrant salt desert festivities to Gir National Park's big cats, the state offers diverse experiences. The Statue of Unity stands tall, blending history with ecology and empowerment. The responsible approach ensures every step in nature leaves a footprint of respect. Gujarat beckons with pristine beaches, misty hills, and cultural richness, promising an eco-friendly adventure that inspires awe and mindfulness.



- **COASTAL TOURISM:** Discover Gujarat's 1,600 km coastline, blending pristine beaches, divine temples, and thrilling adventure. From tranquil Somnath to Blue Flag-certified Shivrajpur, explore hidden gems like Mandvi, Dwarka, Porbandar, and Tithal. Government initiatives aim for world-class destinations while preserving the environment and supporting communities.



- **ISLAND DEVELOPMENT:** Explore the diverse life on Pirotan, delve into Beyt Dwarka's historical richness, and witness Kori Creek's ecological preservation. Gujarat Island Development Authority (GIDA) works to unlock tourism potential, ensuring enriched experiences.
- **BORDER TOURISM (SEEMA DARSHAN):** At Nada Bet, Seema Darshan is an opportunity for travellers to see the workings of an army post on the border of India. Kori Creek Tourism Development Plan has been prepared to enjoy Mangrove walk, Bird and animal watching, Nature trail, and many other facilities.



- **BUSINESS AND TRADE TOURISM:** Gujarat's strong industrial base and business opportunities have resulted in an influx of business travellers attending conferences, trade shows, and exploring investment prospects.
- **EVENT TOURISM:** Gujarat hosts various events and festivals throughout the year, such as G20, Navratri, International Kite Festival, and Rann Utsav, which create spikes in tourist footfall during specific periods.

Gujarat's popularity is bolstered by multiple globally unique sites, which have been developed to boost the tourism sector, including historical, natural and tourist sites. These include: